



LISTENING

#15

1 - Ordering drinks at a café is a common everyday situation. In this lesson, you will listen to a conversation between a customer and a barista. Pay attention to how they greet each other, the way the customer makes a choice, and how the barista responds.

GRABBING A REFRESHER

1 - How did they greet each other?

2 - True or False: The customer was interested in coffee.

3 - What was the customer in the mood for?

4 - What is the Hibiscus Blush, and what ingredients are usually in it?

5 - Do you think the barista missed an opportunity to upsell? Why or why not?

6 - How much was the total for the order?

7 - What did the barista say after the customer paid for the order?

8 - When the order was ready, how did the barista announce it to the customer?

9 - Do you have any preferred drinks that you order or maybe some drinks that you like to make yourself?

10 - What other options could meet the customer's expectations? (Your own)

STARBUCKS SUMMER 2025 MENU

(By Taryn Pire updated May 20, 2025)

It's 2025, so as a former Starbucks barista, I'm never surprised when I see something unconventional on the coffee chain's menu, whether it's spicy lemonade or olive oil coffee. Last year, the company released a limited-time lineup of drinks for spring and summer that included unlikely suspects, like lavender cream cold foam and boba-like popping pearls. This year, the menu features a new espresso bev *and* a fruity snack to go with it.



1. Iced Horchata Oatmilk Shaken Espresso

- **What's In It:** blonde espresso, horchata-flavored syrup, oat milk, ice
- **Price (grande):** \$6

This drink is super fall-coded to me, but tasty enough to sip in the summertime, too. (If you like horchata, odds are you'd want to drink it on a warm Mexican beach anyway, no?) I love the color and gentler roasty notes of the blonde espresso; it makes for a smoother overall flavor, rather than a bold, bitter taste at the forefront. The espresso's warm earthiness plays beautifully with the spices in the horchata flavoring.

Speaking of, I was very impressed with the syrup. I expected it to be cinnamon-forward and kissed with vanilla (which it was, BTW), but what I didn't see coming was the rice milk-inspired sweetness. Between that and the oat milk, the drink is notably horchata-like with its subtle nuttiness and starchy, silky mouthfeel.

If you want it sweeter (or to amp up the cinnamon notes), add a pump of Cinnamon Dolce syrup. Vanilla, caramel, hazelnut and even mocha would work, too.



2. Strawberries & Cream Cake Pop

- **What's In It:** strawberry cream cake mixed with buttercream, dipped in chocolate icing and finished with a summer strawberry design
- **Price:** \$3

As a berry stan and a lover of fruit desserts, I couldn't **wait** for this warm-weather confection to hit stores. I didn't get to taste it in advance, but hoped it would be sweet-tart and balanced with slight sourness from the strawberries. (I find the birthday cake pop to be way too sweet.) Upon finally trying it, I determined it was definitely less cloying than the OG, but still not as acidic as I'd hoped. Its flavor reminded me a lot of Special K Red Berries cereal, down to the bits of strawberry in the filling.



3. Summer-Berry Lemonade Refresher

- **What's In It:** raspberry-blueberry-blackberry Refresher blend, lemonade, raspberry-flavored pearls
- **Price (grande):** \$6

I've sipped *many* hibiscus and green tea lemonades in my day...but I wasn't a fan of this particular mashup. I felt the lemonade overpowered the Refresher's flavor, even with the help of the sweet-tart, berry-flavored pearls.

<https://www.purewow.com/food/starbucks-summer-menu-review>

COMPREHENSION QUESTIONS

1 – How does the Iced Horchata Oatmilk Shaken Espresso capture the traditional flavors of horchata, and what suggestions are given for customizing its sweetness?

2 – What was the reviewer's opinion of the Strawberries & Cream Cake Pop compared to the original Birthday Cake Pop?
